THE BLACKBURN ROVERS FOOTBALL AND ATHLETIC LIMITED

ANNUAL REPORT AND FINANCIAL STATEMENTS

YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2024

(Registered no. 53482)

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THE BLACKBURN ROVERS FOOTBALL AND ATHLETIC LIMITED

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COMPANY INFORMATION

YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2024

DIRECTORS:	S Waggott (Chief Executive Officer) R Gandhi Babu M Sreenivasa Rao R D Coar
VICE PRESIDENTS:	G R Root I R Stanners
HON VICE PRESIDENTS:	Rt Hon J Straw
REGISTERED OFFICE:	Ewood Park Blackburn BB2 4JF
COMPANY NUMBER:	53482
BANKERS:	State Bank of India Limited 15 King Street London EC2V 8EA
AUDITORS:	PM+M Solutions for Business LLP New Century House Greenbank Technology Park Challenge Way Blackburn BB1 5QB

FOOTBALL REVIEW

YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2024

First team

For the first time in seven years, Rovers encountered a mid-season managerial change, as John Eustace took over from Jon Dahl Tomasson and successfully steered the club to Championship safety on a dramatic final day.

Rovers had talismanic top scorer Sammie Szmodics to thank, as the star striker ended the campaign as the Championship's leading marksman with 27 league goals, whilst also becoming the first Rovers' player since Alan Shearer to net over 30 goals in a single season.

Having narrowly missed out on a play-off place on goal difference in the previous campaign, optimism was high heading into Tomasson's second season in charge at Ewood Park.

The squad was boosted with the early arrivals of free agents Arnor Sigurdsson, Sondre Tronstad and Niall Ennis, as well as the loan signings of highly-rated young Premier League players Andy Moran and James Hill, from Brighton and Bournemouth respectively.

Swedish goalkeeper Leo Wahlstedt and German striker Semir Telalovic were also signed on permanent deals, as Rovers cast their transfer net into the European market in search of value-for-money deals.

The departures of Ben Brereton Diaz and Bradley Dack at the end of the 2022-23 campaign left a guaranteed-goals void in the squad, but one man more than stepped up to the mark.

Following an opening day triumph at home to West Bromwich Albion and progress through to the second round of the Carabao Cup, Szmodics got his season up and running with a late brace in the 2-2 draw away to Rotherham United. He repeated the feat in the 2-1 home win over Middlesbrough, as Rovers celebrated the 5,000th league fixture in the club's history in style.

Ryan Hedges netted Rovers' Goal of the Season winner as we picked up our first away win of the season at Watford, before Tomasson's team secured a record 8-0 away win at Harrogate Town, on a proud night for the Academy, with John Buckley (2), Jake Garrett, Zak Gilsenan and James Edmondson all on the scoresheet, whilst Patrick Gamble and Tom Atcheson also made their debuts.

Victory over Cardiff City in the third round of the Carabao Cup set up a mouth-watering tie against Chelsea at Stamford Bridge in November, whilst three straight league wins in October moved Rovers to within a point of the play-off places. Three wins out of four in November ensured Rovers kept pace with the teams at the top, before a disastrous run of results followed – just one win and eight defeats in the next 11 league games – culminated in Tomasson's departure in early February.

January had seen Szmodics continue his fantastic form in front of goal, netting his first career hat-trick in the FA Cup third round triumph over Cambridge United and taking his tally to 20 for the season with a brace against Wrexham in the next round.

Rovers also recruited Connor O'Riordan from Crewe Alexandra, experienced duo Kyle McFadzean and John Fleck, as well as the loan signings of Yasin Ayari from Brighton, Ben Chrisene from Aston Villa and Billy Koumetio from Liverpool, whilst Adam Wharton joined Crystal Palace for a club record fee.

Eustace was unveiled on February 9th and Rovers celebrated the appointment with a 3-1 victory over Stoke City at Ewood Park just 24 hours later. The former Birmingham boss immediately made Rovers harder to beat, picking up valuable points away to Preston North End, Cardiff City and Middlesbrough, along with successive home draws against Norwich City, Millwall and Plymouth Argyle.

Five clean sheets in the final nine fixtures underlined Rovers' new resilience, with Szmodics scoring his 30th goal of the campaign to seal a vital 1-0 victory away at Leeds United, before his final day double at newly-crowned champions Leicester City secured Rovers' Championship status in front of a jubilant away end at the King Power Stadium.

A 30-year anniversary of Rovers' Premiership title triumph, along with a first full season under John Eustace, would await in 2024-25.

Under-21s

Competing on five fronts for the first time in the team's history, Rovers Under-21s enjoyed a strong second half to the season to secure a place in the Premier League 2 play-offs.

Rovers ended the new-look league campaign in 15th position, which saw them paired with runners-up West Ham United in the knockout stage, with the Hammers running out 4-1 winners at Rush Green.

Mike Sheron's side juggled their PL2 commitments with fixtures in four different cup competitions throughout the 2023-24 season, competing in the Premier League Cup, Premier League International Cup, Lancashire Senior Cup and the Central League Cup for the first time.

Zak Gilsenan enjoyed a purple patch in front of goal during the second half of the campaign, netting 11 goals in eight Under-21s games, including braces against Sparta Prague, Sheffield United, Derby County and Aston Villa, as well as the winner against former club Liverpool, prior to picking up an injury.

There were a number of memorable moments throughout the season, including Harry Leonard's hat-trick in a 7-1 win against Preston North End, Igor Tyjon's debut goal against PSV Eindhoven, aged just 15, Isaac Whitehall's long-awaited comeback after over two years out injured, a last-minute winner against Nice at Ewood Park and Leo Duru's development as a rampaging right-back, which saw him rewarded with a new long-term Rovers' deal.

Academy

Rovers' Under-18s lifted the Lancashire FA Youth Cup courtesy of a 3-0 victory over Bolton Wanderers in the final to crown another successful season for the club's Academy.

Further down the age levels, Rovers' Under-16s reached the semi-finals of the Premier League Cup, whilst Rovers' Under-13s reached the final of the National Cup North.

Academy starlet Rory Finneran wrote his name into the Rovers' record books by officially becoming the youngest ever player in the club's history when the midfielder came on in the FA Cup third round victory over Cambridge United at Ewood Park in January, aged just 15 years and 312 days. Finneran also captained Republic of Ireland U16s to glory in the Victory Shield.

Earlier in the campaign, defender Tom Atcheson had become the fourth youngest player in the club's history when he made his debut in Rovers' record 8-0 away win over Harrogate Town in the Carabao Cup, aged just 16 years and 343 days. Fellow scholar James Edmondson scored Rovers' final goal in the game whilst also making his debut for the club.

Throughout the season, there were also first team debuts for Academy graduates Jake Batty, Patrick Gamble and Zak Gilsenan, who scored in each of his first two appearances for the club in the Carabao Cup.

Goalkeeper Nick Michalski and striker Igor Tyjon, who both featured in matchday squads for the first team in 2023-24 aged just 16, also received international recognition with England at youth level.

Women

Playing in the FA Women's Championship for the fifth successive season, Rovers' Women secured an impressive sixth-place finish under new head coach Simon Parker, breaking club records for the highest ever league finish, points won and goals scored in the process.

An eight-game unbeaten run saw Rovers end the season in excellent form and with a tally of 36 points from their 22 league games, thanks to 11 wins and 25 goals scored.

Seven league matches were played at Ewood Park and an attendance record was also broken when 1,500 supporters watched Rovers beat Southampton 2-1 in March, which coincided with Women's Football Weekend.

FOOTBALL REVIEW – continued

YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2024

Lucy Shepherd's dream debut season with the club saw her scoop the Player of the Year prize, whilst Mille Chandarana netted the Goal of the Season award for the second season running. Goalkeeper Alex Brooks was chosen as the Players' Player of the Year, whilst Hannah Coan was named Young Player of the Year. Top scorer Meg Hornby received the Peter Jackson the Jeweller Player of the Match award, whilst Irish international Tyler Toland landed the Newcomer of the Year award.

Rovers' Women will now play all of their 2024-25 Championship fixtures at Ewood Park for the first time in the club's history.

EXECUTIVE REPORT

YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2024

On the pitch, the 2023-24 season saw another raft of changes within the football department and especially across the Men's senior team.

2023-24 was most definitely a season of two halves for the Men's senior team, with a strong first half keeping us in and around the play-off spots, only to see a dramatic fall in form from Christmas onwards that ultimately led to Head Coach Jon Dahl Tomasson's era coming to an end in early February 2024, having been in charge for 19 months.

Assistant Coach Remy Reijnierse and Performance Director Ben Rosen also left their respective roles within the senior backroom coaching staff.

John Eustace came through a selection process for the new Head Coach, with Matt Gardiner and Keith Downing also joining the club as Assistant Head Coaches.

Their remit was crystal clear and solely focused on maintaining Championship status come the end of the 2023- 24 season, especially with the future uplift in broadcasting fees for the 2024-25 season. They ultimately achieved this on the final and very nerve-wracking last day of the season with a dramatic 2-0 away win at Leicester City thanks to both goals coming from the prolific Sammie Szmodics.

With Championship status maintained there were further changes to the football staffing infrastructure with the departures of Director of Football, Gregg Broughton, and Head of Recruitment, Sean Kimberley.

As stated above, the 2023-24 campaign ended with us narrowly avoiding relegation to the third tier of English football, finishing in 19th place, just three points above Birmingham City on 53 points.

With 74 goals conceded, we were third worst in goals against, with only the bottom two clubs Huddersfield Town (79) and Rotherham United (89) conceding more. Whereas, in attack, we were 11th in the league, scoring a total of 60 goals, with the exceptional Szmodics contributing 27 of them, which earned him both the Championship Golden Boot Award plus a move over the summer to the Premier League with Ipswich Town.

In the domestic cup competitions we reached the last 16 of both the FA Cup and League Cup, going out 2-0 to Chelsea at Stamford Bridge and, in the FA Cup, to Newcastle United in a memorable match at Ewood Park that ended in a 1-1 draw, only to see us narrowly lose 4-3 on penalties.

Overall, the first team squad had a very turbulent and inconsistent season, with the real standout performance being that of Szmodics, with an overall goal tally of 33 keeping us both in the Championship and pushing us through to the latter rounds of the cup competitions.

Throughout the 2023-24 season, the Under-21s remained under the experienced guidance of lead coach Mike Sheron, assisted by Paul Butler, competing in the reconfigured Premier League 2 (PL2), plus four different cup competitions.

With the continued integration of the Under-21s with the senior first team squad, the acceleration of our developing players saw them included in the first team planning and preparation for games. However, it was strongly felt that there needed to be improvement in our loaning out of these young players to other clubs to give them the minutes they required to get them ready for the challenges of playing in the relentless schedule of the Championship.

Whilst challenging for Mike and his coaching staff, this exposure of the loaning out for our emerging talent will without doubt accelerate their progress by them playing up to a higher level than that of PL2.

2023-24 was another successful season for the club's Academy, with our Category One Academy programme continuing to develop and produce talented young players aligned to the club's philosophy. Player development was at the forefront and is fundamental to the future growth of the club, so the focus was once again around creating the opportunities and pathway to accelerate them into the first team as quickly as possible.

EXECUTIVE REPORT - continued

YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2024

Records were broken with midfielder Rory Finneran officially becoming the youngest ever player in the club's history at just under 16 years old, after defender Tom Atcheson had become the fourth youngest player in the club's history when he made his debut aged just 16 years and 343 days against Harrogate Town.

Throughout the season, there were also first team debuts for Academy graduates Jake Batty, Patrick Gamble and Zak Gilsenan, while goalkeeper Nick Michalski and striker Igor Tyjon also received international recognition with England at youth level.

We continue to have a very strong and exciting pipeline of young players at Under-18 and Under-21 levels that highlights further encouraging signs of the ongoing string of emerging talent coming out of our Category One Academy. We would like to thank the staff for the exceptional work associated with our youth set-up, led by Academy Manager Stuart Jones.

The Women's team ended the 2023-24 campaign in their highest ever position (6th) in the FA Women's Championship, with also their highest ever points haul of 36, so well done to all concerned.

Seven league matches were played at Ewood Park and an attendance record was also broken when 1,500 supporters watched Rovers beat Southampton 2-1. It is planned that for the 2024-25 season they will now play all their Championship league home games at Ewood Park, whilst continuing to train at the Academy site.

Can we take this opportunity to thank all of the players and backroom staff who served the club over a number of years before leaving at the end of the season and we wish them well in their future careers.

Off the pitch, there were also changes to the Senior Management Team with Mike Cheston, Finance and Club Director, leaving the club after 10 years' service along with Club Secretary Ian Silvester who had spent 11 years at the club. We thank them for their service and wish them both well in the future. Matt Wright was appointed Chief Financial Officer and Brett Baker as Head of Football Administration.

The macro environmental issues continued to be challenging, with energy and food prices still remaining high along with the inflation rates.

The direct impact of all the above factors has resulted in the club incurring higher costs right across the business, but we continued to carefully manage the club's finances to remain in a stable position whilst also being fully compliant within the current Financial Fair Play rules and the Profit and Sustainability parameters.

A wide-ranging programme of refurbishment and renovation has been implemented across all sites, including lots of unseen work at Ewood Park including the cleaning of the roofs and metal structures on the top of the stands, structural work on stands, plus further uplifts to the hospitality lounges.

The Senior Training Centre had work carried out on both external areas and internal rooms, whilst our Academy also underwent some internal improvements. All pitches on the three sites were fully renovated to an exceptionally high level.

Looking to the future, the emphasis and focus for the club continues to be on trying to increase commercial revenue streams under a new structure of a Chief Operating Officer and Head of Commercial.

Key to any growth plan will be the further development of our Business Club, improving match day experience and attendance levels where and whenever possible, continued fan engagement through our ongoing community integration work, whilst attracting new Next Generation supporters via increased links with schools and youth organisations across the region.

The club's Integration & Development Plan will see the club working closely with our award-winning Community Trust to continue to widen our reach into relatively untapped community groups and business networks across the area. The Ewood Express and Next Gen initiatives will continue under Yasir Sufi and Gary Robinson, CEO of the Community Trust.

EXECUTIVE REPORT - continued

YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2024

Once again, special praise must be given to our Community Trust and the Trustees who, under the leadership of Gary Robinson, continually demonstrates outstanding community commitment through a range of critical projects aimed at supporting the most vulnerable members of our community. We should commend them for their inspiring efforts and achievements throughout the year

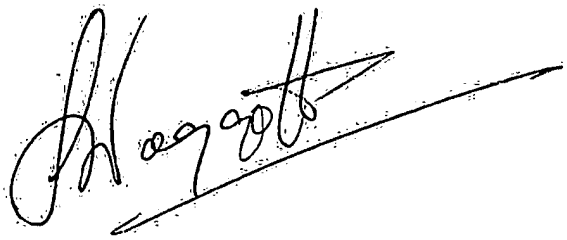
During 2023-24, the club continued to meet regularly with various supporter groups, forums and individuals. With the forthcoming introduction of the Football Governance Bill, along with the appointment of an Independent Football Regulator, it will be imperative to continue and, wherever possible, expand our Fan Engagement through a Fan Engagement Board (FEB).

When officially constituted, the newly-formed FEB, along with the We Are the Rovers Trust / Fans Forum, will develop a strategic plan to increase communication and consultation between the club and the members of all supporter groups.

The Owners and the Board would like to place on record our thanks and appreciation to all those who have supported the club, be they shareholders, corporate clients and partners.

A particular mention should go to our staff for their hard work, loyalty and dedication to the club.

Finally, we must thank the Owners for their continued and steadfast support of the club.



Steve Waggott
Chief Executive Officer
12th December 2024

STRATEGIC REPORT

YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2024

Principal activities

The principal activity of the company throughout the year continues to be that of a professional football club with related commercial activities.

Business review

For the year to 30 June 2024 the company recorded an operating loss before trading of intangible/tangible assets of £17.2m (2023 - loss £17.5m). A profit on trading of intangible assets of £21.2m (2023 - loss £3.1m) brought the pre-tax profit to £3.3m (2023 - loss £20.9m). The key performance indicators are as shown in the table below;

	2023/24 £m	2022/23 £m	2021/22 £m	2020/21 £m	2019/20 £m
Turnover	21.4	21.0	16.6	14.5	13.5
Other operating income	0.0	0.0	0.3	3.3	0.6
Wages & salaries	25.4	25.8	24.4	25.7	25.6
Other operating expenses	13.2	12.7	9.9	7.7	8.6
Operating loss before trading of intangible/tangible assets	(17.2)	(17.5)	(17.4)	(15.6)	(20.1)
Interest payable/(receivable)	(0.7)	0.3	(0.2)	0.5	0.6
Loss before trading of intangible/tangible assets	(17.9)	(17.8)	(17.2)	(16.1)	(20.7)
Tangible fixed asset trading	0	0	0	13.0	0
Intangible fixed asset trading	21.2	(3.1)	6.0	(3.5)	(1.2)
Profit / (Loss) before tax	3.3	(20.9)	(11.2)	(6.6)	(21.9)
Net cash movements in / (out)	2.3	(3.5)	1.6	0.8	0.4
Closing cash and cash equivalent	(12.7)	(15.0)	(11.5)	(13.1)	(13.9)
Finishing position in the Championship	19th	7th	8th	15th	11th
Average league attendance	15,584	14,819	13,501	0	13,836
Wage to turnover %	118.7%	123.0%	147.0%	177.2%	189.6%
Number of live TV games	9	23	11	7	5

The profit made for the year was £3.3m (2023 actual loss £20.9m). Turnover increased by £0.4m which was offset by an increase in operating expenses of £0.5m. Player trading produced a profit of £21.2m (2023 loss £3.1m). Wages and salaries reduced by £0.4m during the year.

As at 30 June 2024, the company had net current liabilities of £142,522,425 and reported an operating loss, before changes in intangible fixed assets, of £17,193,910 for the year. In common with many football clubs, the company may continue to make operating losses and incur net cash outflows depending on a number of variables, including the success of the team in league and cup competitions and the level of transfer activity.

The company is funded through a bank overdraft facility and shareholder loans, and in view of the current financial position, the company remains reliant on its ability to maintain existing and obtain additional funding as necessary.

In managing the finances of the company, the directors remain mindful of the need to ensure the company will comply with the Championship Profitability and Sustainability rules.

As part of the directors' assessment of going concern they have prepared detailed cash flow forecasts for the period to the end of June 2027. These forecasts indicate that the company will require significant funding in addition to the current facilities available to the company.

The amount of additional funding required will be dependent on the net proceeds of any player trading, on field performance, and availability of bank facilities. In view of this the directors have received confirmation from the ultimate parent company, Venkateshwara Hatcheries Private Limited ("VHPL"), that it has sufficient funds and is willing to provide such additional financing as may be required to fund the company, to the extent necessary for the company to continue to trade and to pay its liabilities as and when they become due, for the 12 months following approval of these accounts and thereafter for the foreseeable future even in the event of the bank facility not being renewed.

Further, the ultimate parent company, Venkateshwara Hatcheries Private Limited, has confirmed that it will not recall the amount outstanding of £133,972,098, included in creditors due in less than one year, within twelve months from the date of approval of these financial statements.

The directors would like to bring to the attention of readers of these financial statements, of an ongoing legal matter involving the ultimate parent company, Venkateshwara Hatcheries Private Limited and the Directorate of Enforcement ("ED") in India, whereby the ED have queried the application of funds by one of its subsidiaries, based in the UK, of funds remitted to them by VHPL. It is important to note that this does not include remittances made to The Blackburn Rovers Football and Athletic Limited ("BRFC").

The directors are pleased to confirm that the ED issued a No Objection Certificate, dated 12 March 2024, which confirmed that VHPL has been granted permission to make a remittance of £15 million to its wholly owned subsidiary, namely Venkys London Limited, the immediate parent of BRFC. This permission is subject to certain conditions which have been met already or that will be met prior and subsequent to the remittance being made.

On receipt of the remittance by Venkys London Limited, that company will be able to remit those funds onwards to BRFC without restriction or conditions imposed.

Based on the forecasts prepared, and including the above-mentioned available remittance, the directors are satisfied that the company has sufficient available funds to enable it to meet its liabilities as they fall due for the foreseeable future.

The directors have maintained liquidity through a combination of strong cashflow management and utilisation of player sale proceeds. Furthermore, BRFC has remained compliant with all relevant statutory and football authority regulations (including Profit and Sustainability regulations) in the period under review. In addition, the directors of BRFC have received confirmation from VHPL that it has sufficient funds and is willing to provide additional financing as may be required to continue to fund BRFC to the extent necessary for the company to continue to trade and to pay its liabilities as and when they become due, for at least twelve months from the date of signing these financial statements and thereafter for the foreseeable future.

The directors therefore maintain that the going concern basis of preparation of these financial statements remains appropriate.

Turnover

Turnover has increased to £21.4m (2023 - £21.0m); match day income has decreased by £0.1m (2024 £4.9m: 2023 £5.0m), media income has decreased by £0.2m (2024 £9.5m: 2023 £9.7m) and commercial and other income have increased by £0.7m (2024 £6.9m: 2023 £6.2m) being mainly merchandise income of £0.24m, sponsorship £0.2m and catering £0.1m.

Operating expenses

Operating expenses reflected a decrease in wages and salaries of £0.4m (2024 £25.4: 2023 £25.8m). Other operating expenses increased by £0.5m to £13.2m, (2023 - £12.7m).

Trading of intangible fixed assets

Net intangible fixed asset trading profit was £21.2m (2023– loss £3.1m), an increase of £24.3m. Included in this was amortisation of players' transfer costs which decreased by £1.1m to £2.3m (2023 - £3.4m). Profit on sale of players during the year totalled £23.6m (2023 - profit £0.3m).

Cash flow

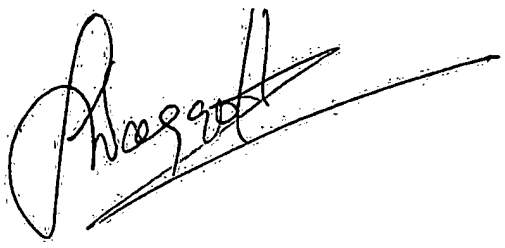
The company expended cash of £13.5m on operating activities compared to £2.6m in 2023. Receipts from player sales of £11.0m (2023 - £5.6m) were offset by £2.8m (2023 - £3.9m) for the acquisition and cost of disposal of player registrations and tangible fixed assets. There was an increase of £0.4m in interest charges, which has resulted in a net inflow in cash of £2.3m in the year (2023 – outflow £3.5m).

Principal risks and uncertainties

The board constantly assesses the threats to the business, by close monitoring of the football sector at its level, and via communication with the company's owners.

Business risks identified include reduced income arising from uncertainty as to progress of the company in the various competitions it participates in. Business risks identified include the possibility of the football clubs relegation from the league in which it competes. This would result in reduced income arising from uncertainty as to the progression of the Company in the various competitions it participates in. During the year under review, the company has traded without restriction under Championship Profit and Sustainability rules.

The company is regulated by the rules of the FA, Football League, Premier League, UEFA and FIFA. Any change to the regulations of these bodies could have an impact on the company as they cover areas such as; competition format, distribution of media income, player eligibility and operation of the transfer market. The board ensures compliance with all relevant rules and regulations, and monitors the impact of any potential changes.



S Waggott
Director
12th December 2024

DIRECTORS' REPORT

YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2024

Directors

S Waggott (Chief Executive Officer)
R Gandhi Babu
M Sreenivasa Rao (Appointed 12.09.23)
R D Coar

The directors present their report and financial statements for the year ended 30 June 2024.

Statement of directors' responsibilities in respect of the Strategic Report, the Directors' Report and the financial statements

The directors are responsible for preparing the Strategic Report, the Directors' Report and the financial statements in accordance with applicable law and regulations.

Company law requires the directors to prepare financial statements for each financial year. Under that law they have elected to prepare the financial statements in accordance with UK Accounting Standards and applicable law (UK Generally Accepted Accounting Practice), including Financial Reporting Standard 102 (The Financial Reporting Standard in the UK and Republic of Ireland).

Under company law the directors must not approve the financial statements unless they are satisfied that they give a true and fair view of the state of affairs of the company and of the profit or loss of the company for that period. In preparing these financial statements, the directors are required to:

- select suitable accounting policies and then apply them consistently;
- make judgments and estimates that are reasonable and prudent;
- state whether applicable UK Accounting Standards have been followed, subject to any material departures disclosed and explained in the financial statements; and
- prepare the financial statements on the going concern basis unless it is inappropriate to presume that the company will continue in business.

The directors are responsible for keeping adequate accounting records that are sufficient to show and explain the company's transactions and disclose with reasonable accuracy at any time the financial position of the company and enable them to ensure that the financial statements comply with the Companies Act 2006. They have general responsibility for taking such steps as are reasonably open to them to safeguard the assets of the company and to prevent and detect fraud and other irregularities.

Proposed dividends

The directors do not recommend the payment of a dividend (2023 - nil).

Going Concern
The directors would like to refer to the Strategic Report on pages 8-10 which sets out a detailed explanation on judgements made by the directors in this regard.

The directors continue to adopt the going concern basis in preparing the financial statements.

Employees and environmental policies

The company is committed to ensuring that it complies with all relevant legislation, in connection with unlawful or unfair discrimination of any kind in its business. The company's employment policies are designed to retain and motivate staff at all levels. During the year to June 2024, the group maintained its 100% waste management recycle percentage, reducing its impact on the environment by handling 167 tonnes of waste and saving over £17,000 in landfill tax. The company constantly monitors energy saving opportunities, and continues to implement policies.

DIRECTORS' REPORT- continued

YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2024

Provision of information to auditor

The directors who held office at the date of approval of this directors' report confirm that, so far as they are each aware, there is no relevant audit information of which the company's auditor is unaware; and each director has taken all the steps that he ought to have taken as a director to make himself aware of any relevant audit information and to establish that the company's auditor is aware of that information.

Auditor

Pursuant to section 487 of the Companies Act 2006, the auditor will be deemed to be reappointed and PM+M Solutions for Business LLP will therefore continue in office.

This report was approved by the board on 12th December 2024 and signed on its behalf by



S Waggott
Director

REGISTERED OFFICE
Ewood Park
Blackburn
BB2 4JF

INDEPENDENT AUDITORS' REPORT TO THE MEMBERS OF THE BLACKBURN ROVERS FOOTBALL AND ATHLETIC LIMITED

Opinion

We have audited the financial statements of The Blackburn Rovers Football and Athletic Limited (the 'company') for the year ended 30 June 2024 which comprise the statement of comprehensive income, the balance sheet, the statement of changes in equity, the statement of cash flows and notes to the financial statements, including significant accounting policies. The financial reporting framework that has been applied in their preparation is applicable law and United Kingdom Accounting Standards, including FRS 102. The Financial Reporting Standard in the UK and Republic of Ireland (United Kingdom Generally Accepted Accounting Practice).

In our opinion the financial statements:

- give a true and fair view of the state of the company's affairs as at 30 June 2024 and of its profit for the year then ended;
- have been properly prepared in accordance with UK Generally Accepted Accounting Practice; and
- have been prepared in accordance with the requirements of the Companies Act 2006.

Basis for opinion

We conducted our audit in accordance with International Standards on Auditing (UK), (ISAs (UK)) and applicable law. Our responsibilities under those standards are further described in Auditor's responsibilities for the audit of the financial statements section of our report. We are independent of the company in accordance with the ethical requirements that are relevant to our audit of the financial statements in the UK, including the FRC's Ethical Standard and we have fulfilled our other ethical responsibilities in accordance with these requirements. We believe that the audit evidence we have obtained is sufficient and appropriate to provide a basis for our opinion.

Conclusions relating to going concern

In auditing the financial statements, we have concluded that the directors' use of the going concern basis of accounting in the preparation of the financial statements is appropriate.
Based on the work we have performed, we have not identified any material uncertainties relating to events or conditions that, individually or collectively, may cast significant doubt on the company's ability to continue as a going concern for a period of at least twelve months from when the financial statements are authorised for issue.
Our responsibilities and the responsibilities of the directors with respect to going concern are described in the relevant sections of this report.

Other information

The other information comprises the information included in the annual report, other than the financial statements and our auditor's report thereon. The directors are responsible for the other information contained within the annual report. Our opinion on the financial statements does not cover the other information and, except to the extent otherwise explicitly stated in our report, we do not express any form of assurance conclusion thereon. Our responsibility is to read the other information and, in doing so, consider whether the other information is materially inconsistent with the financial statements or our knowledge obtained in the course of our audit, or otherwise appears to be materially misstated. If we identify such material inconsistencies or apparent material misstatements, we are required to determine whether this gives rise to a material misstatement in the financial statements themselves. If, based on the work we have performed, we conclude that there is a material misstatement of this other information, we are required to report that fact.

We have nothing to report in this regard.

INDEPENDENT AUDITORS' REPORT TO THE MEMBERS OF THE BLACKBURN ROVERS FOOTBALL AND ATHLETIC LIMITED - continued

Opinion on other matters prescribed by the Companies Act 2006

In our opinion based on the work undertaken in the course of our audit:

- the information given in the Strategic Report and the Directors' Report for the financial year for which the financial statements are prepared is consistent with the financial statements and;
- the Strategic Report and the Directors' Report have been prepared in accordance with applicable legal requirements.

Matters on which we are required to report by exception

In the light of the knowledge and understanding of the company and its environment obtained in the course of the audit, we have not identified material misstatements in the Strategic Report and the Directors' Report.

We have nothing to report in respect of the following matters in relation to which the Companies Act 2006 requires us to report to you if, in our opinion:

- adequate accounting records have not been kept, or returns adequate for our audit have not been received from branches not visited by us; or
- the financial statements are not in agreement with the accounting records and returns; or
- certain disclosures of directors' remuneration specified by law are not made; or
- we have not received all the information and explanations we require for our audit.

Responsibilities of directors

As explained more fully in the Directors' Responsibilities Statement, the directors are responsible for the preparation of the financial statements and for being satisfied that they give a true and fair view, and for such internal control as the directors determine is necessary to enable the preparation financial statements that are free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud or error. In preparing the financial statements the directors are responsible for assessing the company's ability to continue as a going concern, disclosing, as applicable, matters relating to going concern and using the going concern basis of accounting unless the directors either intend to liquidate the company or to cease operations, or have no realistic alternative but to do so.

Auditor's responsibilities for the audit of the financial statements

Our objectives are to obtain reasonable assurance about whether the financial statements, as a whole, are free from material misstatement, whether due to fraud or error, and to issue an auditor's report that includes our opinion. Reasonable assurance is a high level of assurance, but is not a guarantee that an audit conducted in accordance with ISAs (UK) will always detect a material misstatement when it exists. Misstatements can arise from fraud or error are considered material if, individually or in the aggregate, they could reasonably be expected to influence the economic decisions of users taken on the basis of these financial statements.

Extent to which the audit was considered capable of detecting irregularities, including fraud

Irregularities, including fraud, are instances of non-compliance with laws and regulations. We design procedures in line with our responsibilities, outlined above, to detect material misstatements in respect of irregularities, including fraud. The extent to which our procedures are capable of detecting irregularities, including fraud, is detailed below.

We identify and assess the risks of material misstatement of the financial statements, whether due to fraud or error, and then design and perform audit procedures responsive to those risks, including obtaining audit evidence that is sufficient and appropriate to provide a basis for our opinion.

INDEPENDENT AUDITORS' REPORT TO THE MEMBERS OF THE BLACKBURN ROVERS FOOTBALL AND ATHLETIC LIMITED - continued

Identifying and assessing potential risks related to irregularities

In identifying and assessing risks of material misstatement in respect of irregularities, including fraud and non-compliance with laws and regulations, we have considered the following:

- the nature of the industry and sector, control environment and business performance including the design of the company's remuneration policies, key drivers for directors' remuneration, bonus levels and performance targets;
- results of our enquiries of management about their own identification and assessment of the risks of irregularities;
- the matters discussed among the audit engagement team and relevant specialists regarding how and where fraud might occur in the financial statements and any potential indicators of fraud;
- any matters we identified having obtained and reviewed the company's documentation of their policies procedures relating to:
  - identifying, evaluating and complying with laws and regulations and whether they were aware of any instances of non-compliance;
  - detecting and responding to the risks of fraud and whether they have knowledge of any actual, suspected or alleged fraud;
  - the internal controls established to mitigate risks of fraud or non-compliance with laws and regulations.

As a result of these procedures, we considered the opportunities and incentives that may exist within the organisation for fraud and identified the greatest potential for fraud in the following areas: timing of recognition of commercial income, posting of unusual journals and complex transactions; and manipulating the company's performance profit measures and other key performance indicators to meet remuneration targets and externally communicated targets. In common with all audits under ISAs (UK), we are also required to perform specific procedures to respond to the risk of management override.

We also obtained an understanding of the legal and regulatory frameworks that the company operates in, focusing on provisions of those laws and regulations that had a direct effect on the determination of material amounts and disclosures in the financial statements. The key laws and regulations we considered in this context included UK Companies Act, employment law, health and safety, pensions legislation and tax legislation.

Audit response to risks identified

Our procedures to respond to risks identified included the following:

- reviewing the financial statement disclosures and testing to supporting documentation to assess compliance with provisions of relevant laws and regulations described as having a direct effect on the financial statements;
- enquiring of management concerning actual and potential litigation and claims;
- performing analytical procedures to identify any unusual or unexpected relationships that may indicate risks of material misstatement due to fraud;
- reading minutes of meetings of those charged with governance and reviewing correspondence with HMRC; and
- in addressing the identified risks of fraud through management override of controls, testing the appropriateness of journal entries and other adjustments; assessing whether the judgements made in making accounting estimates are indicative of a potential bias; and evaluating the business rationale of any significant transactions that are unusual or outside the normal course of business.

Owing to the inherent limitations of an audit, there is an unavoidable risk that we may not have detected some material misstatements in the financial statements, even though we have properly planned and performed our audit in accordance with auditing standards. For example, the further removed non-compliance with laws and regulations (irregularities) is from the events and transactions reflected in the financial statements, the less likely the inherently limited procedures required by auditing standards would identify it. In addition, as with any audit, there remained a higher risk of non-detection of irregularities, as these may involve collusion, forgery, intentional omissions, misrepresentations, or the override of internal controls. We are not responsible for preventing non-compliance and cannot be expected to detect non-compliance with all laws and regulations.

A further description of our responsibilities is available on the Financial Reporting Councils website at: https://www.frc.org.uk/auditorsresponsibilities. This description forms part of our auditor's report.

INDEPENDENT AUDITORS' REPORT TO THE MEMBERS OF THE BLACKBURN ROVERS FOOTBALL AND ATHLETIC LIMITED - continued

Use of our report

This report is made solely to the company's members, as a body, in accordance with Chapter 3 of Part 16 of the Companies Act 2006. Our audit work has been undertaken so that we might state to the company's members those matters we are required to state to them in an auditor's report and for no other purpose. To the fullest extent permitted by law, we do not accept or assume responsibility to anyone other than the company and the company's members, as a body, for our audit work, for this report, or for the opinions we have formed.

PM a M Solutions for Business LLP.

Miss Helen Louise Clayton BSc FCA (Senior Statutory Auditor)
for and on behalf of PM+M Solutions for Business LLP
Statutory Auditors
12th December 2024
New Century House
Greenbank Technology Park
Challenge Way
Blackburn
Lancashire
BB1 5QB

STATEMENT OF COMPREHENSIVE INCOME

YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2024

	Note	2024 £ Operations excluding trading of tangible/ intangible fixed assets	2024 £ Trading of tangible/ intangible fixed assets	2024 £ Total	2023 £ Total
TURNOVER	4	**21,395,497**	-	**21,395,497**	20,986,668
Operating expenses - non exceptional		**38,589,407**	**2,302,540**	**40,891,947**	41,896,186
OPERATING LOSS	5	**(17,193,910)**	**(2,302,540)**	**(19,496,450)**	(20,909,518)
Profit on disposal of intangible fixed assets	8	-	**23,561,842**	**23,561,842**	349,388
PROFIT / (LOSS) BEFORE INTEREST AND TAXATION		**(17,193,910)**	**21,259,302**	**4,065,392**	(20,560,130)
Interest payable	9			**(839,728)**	(1,018,443)
Interest receivable	9			**108,574**	683,310
PROFIT / (LOSS) BEFORE TAXATION				**3,334,238**	(20,895,263)
Taxation	10			-	-
PROFT / (LOSS) FOR THE YEAR				**3,334,238**	(20,895,263)

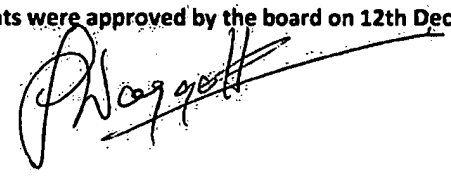
The notes on pages 21 to 35 form an integral part of these financial statements.

BALANCE SHEET

AS AT 30 JUNE 2024

	Note	2024 £	2024 £	2023 £	2023 £
FIXED ASSETS					
Intangible fixed assets	11		3,183,432		4,275,816
Tangible fixed assets	12		23,017,335		23,503,167
Investments	13		100		100
			26,200,867		27,779,083
CURRENT ASSETS					
Stock	14	833,689		332,610	
Debtors - amounts falling due within one year	15	2,902,964		7,423,841	
- amounts falling due after one year	16	12,290,000			
Cash at bank and in hand	17	582,607		25,900	
		16,609,260		7,782,351	
CREDITORS:					
- amounts falling due within one year	18	(159,131,685)		(154,283,153)	
NET CURRENT LIABILITIES			(142,522,425)		(146,500,802)
TOTAL CURRENT ASSETS LESS CURRENT LIABILITIES			(116,321,558)		(118,721,719)
CREDITORS:					
- amounts falling due after one year	19		(1,091,422)		(2,004,533)
DEFERRED GRANTS	22		(717,592)		(738,558)
NET LIABILITIES			(118,130,572)		(121,464,810)
CAPITAL AND RESERVES					
Called up share capital	23		198,227,484		198,227,484
Revaluation reserve	24		1,295,825		1,295,825
Profit and loss account	24		(317,653,881)		(320,988,119)
SHAREHOLDERS' DEFICIT			(118,130,572)		(121,464,810)

The financial statements were approved by the board on 12th December 2024 and signed on its behalf by:



S Waggott, Director

The Blackburn Rovers Football and Athletic Limited (Registered no. 53482)

The notes on pages 21 to 35 form an integral part of these financial statements.

STATEMENT OF CHANGES IN EQUITY

YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2024

	Note	Share capital	Revaluation reserve	Profit and Loss account	Total equity
		£	£	£	£
At 1 July 2023		**198,227,484**	**1,295,825**	**(320,988,119)**	**(121,464,810)**
Comprehensive loss for the year					
Profit for the year		-	-	**3,334,238**	**3,334,238**
Issue of share capital	**23**	-	-	-	-
At 30 June 2024		**198,227,484**	**1,295,825**	**(317,653,881)**	**(118,130,572)**

	Note	Share capital	Revaluation reserve	Profit and Loss account	Total equity
		£	£	£	£
At 1 July 2022		176,571,484	1,295,825	(300,092,856)	(122,225,547)
Comprehensive loss for the year					
Loss for the year		-	-	(20,895,263)	(20,895,263)
Issue of share capital	**23**	21,656,000	-	-	21,656,000
At 30 June 2023		198,227,484	1,295,825	(320,988,119)	(121,464,810)

The notes on pages 21 to 35 form an integral part of these financial statements.

STATEMENT OF CASH FLOWS

YEAR ENDED 30 JUNE 2024

	2024	2023
	£	£
CASH FLOWS FROM OPERATING ACTIVITIES		
Profit / (Loss) for the financial year	**3,334,238**	(20,895,263)
Adjustments for:		
Amortisation of intangible fixed assets	**2,302,540**	3,419,469
Profit on sale of intangible fixed assets	**(23,561,842)**	(349,388)
Depreciation of tangible fixed assets	**1,135,880**	1,133,016
(Profit) / Loss on sale of tangible fixed assets	**(4,875)**	137,835
Release of deferred grants	**(98,346)**	(96,660)
Interest received	**(108,574)**	(683,310)
Interest paid	**839,728**	1,018,443
(Increase) / Decrease in stock	**(501,079)**	177,426
Decrease in amounts owed by group undertaking	**6,343,682**	9,848,822
(Increase) / Decrease in debtors	**(1,291,439)**	614,932
(Decrease) / Increase in creditors	**(1,139,609)**	3,392,132
Net cash outflow from operations	**(12,749,696)**	(2,282,546)
Net Interest (paid) / received	**(731,154)**	(335,133)
Net cash outflow from operating activities	**(13,480,850)**	(2,617,679)
CASH FLOWS FROM INVESTING ACTIVITIES		
Payments to acquire intangible fixed assets	**(2,453,480)**	(3,472,433)
Payments to acquire tangible fixed assets	**(352,123)**	(474,778)
Payments to dispose of intangible fixed assets	**(29,379)**	-
Grant received	**77,380**	120,779
Receipts from disposal of intangible fixed assets	**10,979,234**	5,567,003
Receipts from disposal of tangible fixed assets	**4,875**	5,558
Net cash inflow from investing activities	**8,226,507**	1,746,129
CASH FLOWS FROM FINANCING ACTIVITIES		
Increase in amounts owed to group undertakings	**10,988,700**	266,542
Increase in other loans	**-**	200,000
Repayment of other loans and hire purchase creditor	**(3,403,487)**	(3,068,923)
Net cash inflow / (outflow) from financing activities	**7,585,213**	(2,602,381)
Increase / (decrease) in cash and cash equivalents	**2,330,870**	(3,473,931)
MOVEMENT IN CASH AND CASH EQUIVALENTS IN THE YEAR		
Increase / (Decrease) in cash and cash equivalents	**2,330,870**	(3,473,931)
At 1 July 2023	**(14,966,470)**	(11,492,539)
At 30 June 2024	**(12,635,600)**	(14,966,470)

The notes on pages 21 to 35 form an integral part of these financial statements.

1 COMPANY INFORMATION

The company is a private company, limited by shares and incorporated in England and Wales. The registered office is Ewood Park, Blackburn, BB2 4JF. The principal activity is that of a professional football club with related commercial activities.

2 ACCOUNTING POLICIES

Basis of preparation of the financial statements

The financial statements have been prepared under the historical cost convention, as modified by the revaluation of freehold property and in accordance with Financial Reporting Standard 102, the Financial Reporting Standard applicable in the United Kingdom and the Republic of Ireland and the Companies Act 2006.

The financial statements are prepared in sterling which is the functional currency of the company. Monetary amounts in these financial statements are rounded to the nearest £.

The preparation of financial statements in compliance with FRS 102 requires the use of certain critical accounting estimates. It also requires management to exercise judgment in applying the company's accounting policies (see note 3).

The financial statements contain information about The Blackburn Rovers Football and Athletic Limited as an individual company and do not contain consolidated financial information as the parent company of a group. The company has taken advantage of the exemption available to it under s400 of the Companies Act 2006 from the requirement to prepare consolidated financial statements as it and its subsidiary undertaking are included within the consolidated financial statements of Venkys London Limited.

The principal accounting policies applied by the company are described below.

Going concern

As at 30 June 2024, the company had net current liabilities of £142,522,425 and reported an operating loss, before changes in intangible fixed assets, of £17,193,910 for the year. In common with many football clubs, the company may continue to make operating losses and incur net cash outflows depending on a number of variables, including the success of the team in league and cup competitions and the level of transfer activity.

The company is funded through a bank overdraft facility and shareholder loans, and in view of the current financial position, the company remains reliant on its ability to maintain existing and obtain additional funding as necessary.

In managing the finances of the company, the directors remain mindful of the need to ensure the company will comply with the Championship Profitability and Sustainability rules.

As part of the directors' assessment of going concern they have prepared detailed cash flow forecasts for the period to the end of June 2027. These forecasts indicate that the company will require significant funding in addition to the current facilities available to the company.

The amount of additional funding required will be dependent on the net proceeds of any player trading, on field performance, and availability of bank facilities. In view of this the directors have received confirmation from the ultimate parent company, Venkateshwara Hatcheries Private Limited ("VHPL"), that it has sufficient funds and is willing to provide such additional financing as may be required to fund the company, to the extent necessary for the company to continue to trade and to pay its liabilities as and when they become due, for the 12 months following approval of these accounts and thereafter for the foreseeable future even in the event of the bank facility not being renewed.

2 ACCOUNTING POLICIES - continued

Going concern (continued)

Further, the ultimate parent company, Venkateshwara Hatcheries Private Limited (VHPL), has confirmed that it will not recall the amount outstanding of £133,972,098, included in creditors due in less than one year, within twelve months from the date of approval of these financial statements.

The directors would like to bring to the attention of readers of these financial statements, of an ongoing legal matter involving the ultimate parent company, Venkateshwara Hatcheries Private Limited and the Directorate of Enforcement ("ED") in India, whereby the ED have queried the application of funds by one of its subsidiaries, based in the UK, of funds remitted to them by VHPL. It is important to note that this does not include remittances made to The Blackburn Rovers Football and Athletic Limited ("BRFC").

The directors are pleased to confirm that the ED issued a No Objection Certificate, dated 12 March 2024, which confirmed that VHPL has been granted permission to make a remittance of £15 million to its wholly owned subsidiary, namely Venkys London Limited, the immediate parent of BRFC. This permission is subject to certain conditions which have been met already or that will be met prior and subsequent to the remittance being made. On receipt of the remittance by Venkys London Limited, that company will be able to remit those funds onwards to BRFC without restriction or conditions imposed.

Based on the forecasts prepared, and including the above-mentioned available remittance, the directors are satisfied that the company has sufficient available funds to enable it to meet its liabilities as they fall due for the foreseeable future.

The directors have maintained liquidity through a combination of strong cashflow management and utilisation of player sale proceeds. Furthermore, BRFC has remained compliant with all relevant statutory and football authority regulations (including Profit and Sustainability regulations) in the period under review.

In addition, the directors of BRFC have received confirmation from VHPL that it has sufficient funds and is willing to provide additional funding as may be required to fund BRFC to the extent necessary for the company to continue to trade and pay its liabilities as and when they become due, for at least twelve months from the date of signing these financial statements.

Foreign currencies

Transactions in foreign currencies are recorded using the rate of exchange ruling at the date of the transaction. Monetary assets and liabilities denominated in foreign currencies are translated using the rate of exchange ruling at the balance sheet date and the gains or losses on translation are included in the profit and loss account.

Turnover and income recognition

Turnover is stated net of Value Added Tax and amounts due to the Premier League, Football League, Football Association and visiting football clubs. It includes gate receipts, executive boxes, sponsorships, merchandising, advertising, television fees, Football / Premier League pool and sundry related income.

Gate receipts and other match day revenue is recognised over a football season as the matches occur. Merchandising income is recognised at the point of sale. Other revenue comprising media and commercial income is apportioned evenly over the football season or contract term as appropriate.

Revenue is recognised to the extent that it is probable that the economic benefits will flow to the company and the revenue can be reliably measured. Revenue is measured as the fair value of the consideration received or receivable, excluding discounts, rebates, value added tax and other sales taxes.

2 ACCOUNTING POLICIES - continued

Intangible fixed assets

The costs associated with the acquisition of new players' registrations are capitalised as intangible fixed assets. These costs are fully amortised, in equal annual instalments, over the period of the player's initial contract. The external costs of securing the extension or renewal of an existing contract both for internally produced and externally purchased players are capitalised and amortised over the period of the players' new contract.

Signing on fees and other contingent fees payable to players as a result of the occurrence of one or more uncertain future events are expensed when they occur.

Impairment

The carrying amounts of the company's assets are reviewed for impairment when events or changes in circumstances indicate that the carrying amount of the asset may not be recoverable. If any such indication exists, the asset's recoverable amount is estimated.

An impairment loss is recognised whenever the carrying amount of an asset or its income-generating unit exceeds its recoverable amount. Impairment losses are recognised in the profit and loss account.

Impairment losses recognised in respect of income-generating units are allocated to the carrying amount of the intangible fixed assets in the unit on a pro rata or more appropriate basis. An income generating unit is the smallest identifiable group of assets that generates income that is largely independent of the income streams from other assets or groups of assets.

The recoverable amount of fixed assets is the greater of their net realisable value and value in use. In assessing value in use, the expected future cash flows are discounted to their present value using a pre-tax discount rate that reflects current market assessments of the rate of return expected on an equally risky investment. For an asset that does not generate largely independent income streams, the recoverable amount is determined for the income-generating unit to which the asset belongs.

Tangible fixed assets and depreciation

Tangible fixed assets are stated at cost or valuation less depreciation. Depreciation is provided at rates calculated to write off the cost or valuation of fixed assets, less their estimated residual value, over their expected useful economic lives on the following bases:

Motor vehicles	-	25% per annum on cost
Fixtures and fittings	-	10% per annum on cost
Computer equipment	-	20% per annum on cost
Freehold buildings	-	2% per annum on cost

No depreciation has been provided on freehold land.

Revaluation of tangible fixed assets

As permitted by the provisions of FRS 102 the company has elected not to adopt a policy of revaluation of tangible fixed assets. The company will retain the book value of land and buildings, previously revalued in 1995 and will not update that valuation.

2 ACCOUNTING POLICIES - continued

Fixed asset investments

Investment in subsidiary is measured at cost less any accumulated impairment losses. A subsidiary is an entity controlled by the group. Control is the power to govern the financial and operating policies of the entity so as to obtain benefits from its activities.

Stock

Stock is valued at the lower of cost and net realisable value after making due allowance for obsolete and slow moving stock.

Debtors

Short term debtors are measured at transaction price, less any impairment. Loans receivable are measured initially at fair value, net of transaction costs, and are measured subsequently at amortised cost using the effective interest method, less any impairment.

Cash and cash equivalents

Cash is represented by cash in hand and deposits with financial institutions repayable without penalty on notice of not more than 24 hours. Cash equivalents are highly liquid investments that mature in no more than three months from the date of acquisition and that are readily convertible to known amounts of cash with insignificant risk of change in value.

In the statement of cash flows, cash and cash equivalents are shown net of bank overdrafts that are repayable on demand and form an integral part of the company's cash management.

Creditors

Short term creditors are measured at the transaction price. Other financial liabilities, including bank loans, are measured initially at fair value, net of transaction costs, and are measured subsequently at amortised cost using the effective interest method.

Financial instruments

The company only enters into basic financial instruments transactions that result in the recognition of financial assets and liabilities like trade and other accounts receivable and payable, loans from banks and other third parties, loans to related parties and investments in non-puttable ordinary shares.

Debt instruments (other than those wholly repayable or receivable within one year), including loans and other accounts receivable and payable, are initially measured at present value of the future cash flows and subsequently at amortised cost using the effective interest method. Debt instruments that are payable or receivable within one year, typically trade payables or receivables, are measured, initially and subsequently, at the undiscounted amount of the cash or other consideration expected to be paid or received. However, if the arrangements of a short-term instrument constitute a financing transaction, such as the payment of a trade debt deferred beyond normal business terms or financed at a rate of interest that is not a market rate or in case of an out-right short-term loan not at market rate, the financial asset or liability is measured initially at the present value of the future cash flow discounted at a market rate of interest for a similar debt instrument and subsequently at amortised cost.

2 ACCOUNTING POLICIES - continued

Financial instruments (continued)

Financial assets that are measured at cost and amortised cost are assessed at the end of each reporting period for objective evidence of impairment. If objective evidence of impairment is found, an impairment loss is recognised in the profit and loss account.

For financial assets measured at cost less impairment, the impairment loss is measured as the difference between an asset's carrying amount and best estimate, which is an approximation of the amount that the company would receive for the asset if it were to be sold at the balance sheet date.

Leases

Assets acquired under finance leases are capitalised and the outstanding future lease obligations are shown in creditors. Operating lease rentals are charged to the profit and loss account on a straight line basis over the period of the lease.

Grants

Grants are accounted for under the accruals model as permitted by FRS 102.

Revenue grants are credited to profit and loss account in the same period in which the revenue expenditure to which they relate is charged. Capital based grants are credited to revenue over the life of the asset to which they relate. The deferred element of grants is included as deferred income.

The useful lives are as follows:

Freehold buildings	50 years
Fixtures and fittings	10 years

Taxation

The charge for taxation is based on the loss for the year and takes into account taxation deferred because of timing differences between the treatment of certain items for taxation and accounting purposes.

Deferred tax is recognised, without discounting, in respect of all timing differences between the treatment of certain items for taxation and accounting purposes which have arisen but not reversed by the balance sheet date, except as otherwise required by FRS 102.

A deferred tax asset is recognised only if it can be regarded as more likely than not that there will be suitable taxable profits from which the future reversal of the underlying timing differences can be deducted.

Pensions

The company is making contributions in respect of its share of the deficit of the defined benefit section of the Football League Pension and Life Assurance Scheme (the "Scheme").

Under the provisions of FRS 102 the Scheme is treated as a defined benefit multi-employer scheme. The financial statements provide for the company's estimated share of the Football League Limited Pension and Life Assurance deficit. The value provided is based on the current actuarial valuation dated 31 August 2023. Contributions are made as advised by the scheme actuary.

2 ACCOUNTING POLICIES - continued

Pensions (continued)

The company also makes contributions to defined contribution pension schemes for certain employees. The employer's contributions are charged to the profit and loss account in the year in which the liability to pay arises.

Differences between contributions payable in the year and contributions actually paid are shown as accruals or prepayments in the balance sheet.

Borrowing costs

All borrowing costs are recognised in the profit and loss account in the year in which they are incurred.

Operating Costs

The directors consider that all operating costs incurred can most accurately be categorised as administration costs.

3 JUDGMENT IN APPLYING ACCOUNTING POLICIES AND KEY SOURCES OF ESTIMATION UNCERTAINTY

In the process of applying the company's accounting policies, which are described above, management has made some judgments that have a significant effect on the amounts recognised in the financial statements. These also include key assumptions concerning the future, and other key sources of estimation uncertainty at the balance sheet date. The main areas of judgement that have a significant risk of causing a material adjustment to the carrying amounts of assets and liabilities within the next financial year are in relation to revenue recognition of central distributions from football authorities and impairment of fixed assets.

4 TURNOVER

An analysis of turnover by class of business is given below:

	2024	2023
	£	£
Matchday	**4,937,365**	5,045,374
Media	**9,481,450**	9,697,500
Commercial	**6,942,919**	6,141,669
Other	**33,763**	102,125
	21,395,497	20,986,668

5 OPERATING LOSS

The operating profit/loss is stated after charging / (crediting):

		2024	2023
		£	£
Amortisation of intangible fixed assets		**2,302,540**	3,419,469
Depreciation of tangible fixed assets:	owned by the company	**1,024,389**	1,057,872
	under hire purchase	**111,491**	75,144
Profit/loss on disposal of tangible fixed assets		**(4,875)**	137,835
Auditors' remuneration:	audit work	**39,650**	34,000
	non audit work	**16,561**	8,625
Operating lease payments		**391,508**	382,967
Deferred grants release		**(98,346)**	(96,660)

6 STAFF COSTS

	2024	2023
	£	£
Wages and salaries	**21,981,656**	22,499,023
Social security costs	**2,978,274**	3,096,097
Other pension costs	**483,441**	199,086
	25,443,371	25,794,206

The average number of employees, including directors, during the year was as follows:

	2024	2023
	No.	No.
Senior football players and management	**80**	79
Academy football players and management	**71**	67
Commercial, sponsorship, media and merchandising	**20**	22
Administration	**21**	21
Building, ground and pitch maintenance	**30**	32
	222	221

7 DIRECTORS' REMUNERATION

Emoluments for services as directors:

	Salaries	Pension	Benefits	Total
	£	£	£	£
Executive directors:				
2024	**571,392**	**165,752**	**29,096**	**766,240**
2023	473,266	21,001	61,655	555,922

During the year 2 (2023 - 2) directors were members of a money purchase pension scheme.

Remuneration disclosed above includes the following amounts paid to the highest paid director:

	2024	2023
	£	£
Remuneration for qualifying services	**433,028**	308,888
Company pension contributions	**159,002**	12,001

Included in the disclosures above are amounts payable in respect of employment in previous accounting periods, which have been defined in quantum in the current accounting period. These amounts are not material and therefore a prior year adjustment has not been necessary.

8 TRANSFER FEES AND ASSOCIATED COSTS

	2024	2023
	£	£
Amortisation of intangible fixed assets	**(2,302,540)**	(3,419,469)
Profit on disposal of intangible fixed assets	**23,561,842**	349,388
	21,259,302	(3,070,081)

9 NET INTEREST PAYABLE

	2024	2023
	£	£
Interest receivable		
Short term deposits and other interest	**108,574**	683,310
Interest payable		
On bank overdrafts and other loans	**(798,618)**	(1,003,119)
Hire purchase interest	**(41,110)**	(15,324)
	(839,728)	(1,018,443)
Net interest payable	**(731,154)**	(335,133)

10 TAXATION

	2024	2023
	£	£
The tax credit comprises:		
UK corporation tax		
Adjustment in respect of prior year	-	-
Tax on loss on ordinary activities	-	-

The actual tax charge for the current year differs from the standard rate of 25% (2023 - 19%) for the reasons set out in the following reconciliation:

Loss on ordinary activities before tax	**3,334,238**	(20,895,263)
Tax on profit/loss on ordinary activities at 25% (2023 - 19%)	**833,560**	(4,282,670)
Effects of :		
Expenses not deductible for corporation tax purposes	**7,230**	3,509
Non-taxable income	**(24,587)**	(19,811)
Adjustment in respect of prior years	-	-
Chargeable gain indexation	-	-
Deferred tax not recognised	**(819,214)**	4,298,031
Other permanent difference	**3,011**	941
Total amount of tax	-	-

Taxable losses from previous years are available for offset against future taxable profits. A deferred tax asset has not been recognised in respect of those losses as the company does not anticipate taxable profits to arise within the foreseeable future. The estimated value of the deferred tax asset not recognised, measured at a standard rate of 25% (2023 - 25%) is £74m (2023 - £75m).

11 INTANGIBLE FIXED ASSETS

		Player registrations
		£
Cost	At 1 July 2023	**12,775,013**
	Additions	**1,390,156**
	Disposals	**(1,014,012)**
	At 30 June 2024	**13,151,157**
Amortisation	At 1 July 2023	**8,499,197**
	Charge for the year	**2,302,540**
	On disposals	**(834,012)**
	At 30 June 2024	**9,967,725**
Net book value	**At 30 June 2024**	**3,183,432**
	At 1 July 2023	4,275,816

12 TANGIBLE FIXED ASSETS

	Freehold land and buildings	Fixtures, fittings and computer equipment	Motor vehicles	Total
	£	£	£	£
Cost or valuation				
At 1 July 2023	**39,402,025**	**10,262,731**	**278,957**	**49,943,713**
Additions	**345,642**	**300,056**	**4,350**	**650,048**
Disposals	-	**(18,350)**	-	**(18,350)**
At 30 June 2024	**39,747,667**	**10,544,437**	**283,307**	**50,575,411**
At cost	**4,672,667**	**10,544,437**	**283,307**	**15,500,411**
At valuation - 1995	**35,075,000**	-	-	**35,075,000**
	39,747,667	**10,544,437**	**283,307**	**50,575,411**
Depreciation				
At 1 July 2023	**17,451,747**	**8,783,820**	**204,979**	**26,440,546**
Charge for the year	**781,785**	**320,732**	**33,363**	**1,135,880**
On disposals	-	**(18,350)**	-	**(18,350)**
At 30 June 2024	**18,233,532**	**9,086,202**	**238,342**	**27,558,076**
Net book value				
At 30 June 2024	**21,514,135**	**1,458,235**	**44,965**	**23,017,335**
At 1 July 2023	21,950,278	1,478,911	73,978	23,503,167

The net book value of assets held under hire purchase contracts is £617,517 (2023 - £304,388), depreciation for the year on assets held under hire purchase contracts was £111,491 (2023 - £75,144). Included within freehold land and buildings is land at a value of £2,645,000 which has not been depreciated.

On the historical cost basis, land and buildings included at valuation would have been included as follows:

	2024	2023
	£	£
Deemed historical cost of revalued assets	**34,099,059**	34,099,059
Cumulative depreciation based on deemed historical cost	**(16,961,052)**	(16,301,898)
Deemed historical cost net book value	**17,138,007**	17,797,161

13 FIXED ASSET INVESTMENT

	Shares in Group Undertakings
	£
Cost	**100**
At 30 June 2024	**100**

The investment represents 100% of the ordinary share capital of Blackburn Rovers Women Football Club Limited, registered in the UK. The subsidiary is a professional football club.

14 STOCK

	2024	2023
	£	£
Goods held for resale	**833,689**	332,610

The difference between purchase price or production cost of stocks and their replacement cost is not material.

Stock recognised in cost of sales during the year as an expense was £774,038 (2023 - £684,674).

15 DEBTORS - amounts falling due within one year

	2024	2023
	£	£
Trade debtors	**906,195**	423,145
Football related debtors	**605,943**	74,577
Amounts owed by group undertaking	**-**	6,343,682
Other debtors	**249,864**	32,381
Prepayments and accrued income	**1,140,962**	550,056
	2,902,964	7,423,841

See note 29 for details of repayment terms attaching to amounts owed by group undertaking.

16 DEBTORS - amounts falling due after more than one year

	2024	2023
	£	£
Football related debtors	**12,290,000**	-
	12,290,000	-

17 CASH AND CASH EQUIVALENTS

	2024	2023
	£	£
Cash at bank and in hand	**582,607**	25,900
Bank overdraft	**(13,218,207)**	(14,992,370)
	(12,635,600)	(14,966,470)

18 CREDITORS - amounts falling due within one year

	2024	2023
	£	£
Bank overdraft	**13,218,207**	14,992,370
Amounts owed to parent undertaking	**133,972,098**	123,052,900
EFL Loan	**-**	2,971,468
Other Loans	**-**	200,000
Trade creditors	**2,583,565**	3,057,484
Football related creditors	**2,520,961**	2,521,356
Social security and other taxes	**1,737,799**	1,597,172
Other creditors	**269,552**	361,024
Pension deficit	**138,848**	136,606
Hire purchase creditors	**215,376**	92,214
Accruals and deferred income	**4,475,279**	5,300,559
	159,131,685	154,283,153

The amounts due to the parent company of £133,972,098 (2023 - £123,052,900) have been treated as falling due within one year as this is the technical legal status of the loans at the balance sheet date. As described in note 2, subsequent to the year end the parent company has confirmed that, as in previous years, it will provide sufficient financing to support the company for the twelve months following approval of these accounts and will not recall the amount included in creditors due in less than one year, within 12 months of the date of approval of these financial statements.

The amounts owed to the parent undertaking above are interest free with no fixed date for repayment.
The bank overdraft facility expires on 9 May 2025. The directors believe the facility will be renewed on acceptable terms and conditions as in previous years.

Please refer to the strategic report for more detail on the directors' assessment of going concern.
The bank overdraft is secured by a corporate guarantee from the holding company, Venkys London Limited. Interest is paid upon the facility at 2.0% over BOE base rate.

Hire purchase creditors are secured on the assets to which they relate.

19 CREDITORS - amounts falling due after more than one year

	2024	2023
	£	£
Other Loans	**116,131**	147,733
Hire purchase creditors	**358,841**	206,800
Football related creditors	**616,450**	1,650,000
	1,091,422	2,004,533

20 FINANCIAL INSTRUMENTS

	2024	2023
	£	£
Financial assets measured at fair value through profit or loss	**582,607**	25,900
Financial assets that are debt instruments measured at amortised cost	**14,052,002**	6,873,785
	14,634,609	6,899,685
Financial liabilities measured at amortised cost	**158,369,177**	151,371,313

Financial assets measured at fair value through profit or loss comprise cash and bank balances.

Financial assets measured at amortised cost comprise trade and other debtors.

Financial liabilities measured at amortised cost comprise creditors, excluding deferred government grants and tax and social security.

21 HIRE PURCHASE CREDITORS

Minimum lease payments under hire purchase fall due as follows:

	2024	2023
	£	£
Within 1 year	**215,376**	92,214
Between 1 and 2 years	**207,459**	79,539
Between 2 and 5 years	**151,382**	127,261
	574,217	299,014

22 DEFERRED GRANTS

	2024	2023
	£	£
Outstanding at beginning of year	**738,558**	714,439
Grant received	**77,380**	120,779
Released to profit and loss account in the year	**(98,346)**	(96,660)
Outstanding at end of year	**717,592**	738,558
Amount to be released within one year	**108,738**	96,660

23 CALLED UP SHARE CAPITAL

	2024	2023
	£	£
Allotted, called up - fully paid		
198,227,484 ordinary shares of £1 each	**198,227,484**	198,227,484

24 RESERVES

Profit and loss reserve:

The profit and loss reserve represents cumulative profits or losses. The current year profit and loss reserve amounts to a deficit of £317,653,881 (2023 - £320,988,119)

Revaluation reserve:

The revaluation reserve represents the cumulative effect of revaluations of freehold land and buildings. The current year revaluation reserve amounts to £1,295,825 (2023 - £1,295,825)

25 PENSIONS

Pension contributions are paid by the company into the personal pension schemes of certain employees. The assets of their schemes are held separately from those of the company in independently administered funds. The contributions paid during the year amounted to £483,441 (2023 - £199,086), of which £181,478 (2023 - £32,108) was outstanding at year end.

The company is a participating employer in the Football League Limited Pension and Life Assurance Scheme (the "Scheme"). Accrual of benefits under a final salary basis was suspended with effect from 31 August 1999 following an actuarial review, which revealed a substantial deficit. The company was advised of its share of the deficit in the Scheme and the contributions required to make good that deficit, based on the latest actuarial valuation at 1 September 2023. The increase in the deficit in the year, which has been charged as an expense, amounted to £107,244 (2023 - £NIL). The company's share of this deficit is currently estimated to be £254,979 (2023 - £284,339). This deficit has been provided for in these accounts and is included in creditors.

26 POTENTIAL FUTURE PLAYER REGISTRATION PAYMENTS

Under the terms of certain contracts for the purchase of players' registrations, future payments may be due, dependent upon the success of the team and/or the individual players. Similar terms exist in contracts for sales of players' registrations.

Any amount payable in relation to playing appearance and team performances are recognised when the event occurs. The maximum potential payment for amounts due to football clubs and other third parties for first team players is £6.5m (2023 - £5.9m). Any amount receivable in relation to playing appearances and team performances are recognised when the event occurs. The maximum potential receipt for amounts due from football clubs and other third parties for first team players is £5.6m (2023 - £4.1m).

27 CAPITAL COMMITMENTS

At 30 June 2024 the company had capital commitments as follows:

	2024	2023
	£	£
Contracted for but not provided in these accounts net of grants receivable	**244,754**	120,842

28 OTHER COMMITMENTS

At 30 June 2024 the company had future minimum lease payments under non cancellable operating leases as follows:

	2024	2023
	£	£
Within 1 year	**378,243**	378,009
Between 1 and 5 years	**19,777**	36,807

29 RELATED PARTY TRANSACTIONS

During the year the company entered into the following transactions with related parties:

The company received rent and other income of £364,261 (2023 - £258,548) from Blackburn Rovers Community Trust. In addition certain expenses were incurred and recharged to Blackburn Rovers Community Trust. At the balance sheet date an amount of £241,766 was owed by the Trust to the company (2023 - £21,918) in respect of these transactions, and is disclosed within other creditors / debtors. At 30 June 2024 Blackburn Rovers Community Trust had seven trustees, of which two were directors of The Blackburn Rovers Football and Athletic Limited.

In June 2021 the company sold the Senior training ground and related property for £17,300,000 to Venkateshwara London Limited, a subsidiary of the ultimate parent company, Venkateshwara Hatcheries Pvt. Ltd. The proceeds carried interest at 4% above the State Bank of India base rate and interest arising on the loan in the period was £88,887 (2023 - £683,259). The company has entered into a lease to continue to use the Senior training ground and rent of £356,004 arose for the period to 30 June 2024 (2023 - £356,004). The loan was repaid in full on 25th October 2023.

30 PARENT COMPANY

The company is a subsidiary undertaking of Venkys London Limited, with Venkateshwara Hatcheries Pvt. Ltd. being the ultimate parent company, which is incorporated in India. Ultimate control is held by Mrs Anuradha J Desai, Mr B Venkatesh Rao and Mr B Balaji Rao.

The largest group in which the results of the company are consolidated is that headed by Venkys London Limited, incorporated in the United Kingdom. The consolidated financial statements of this group are available to the public and obtainable from Companies House.

31 POST BALANCE SHEET EVENTS

Since the balance sheet date the company has entered into transfer agreements amounting to net transfer fees receivable of £12.4m (2023 - £3.4m receivable).